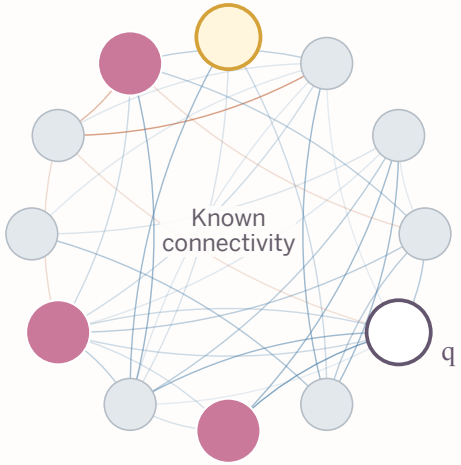
Better risk estimates do not necessarily
make better recording decisions.



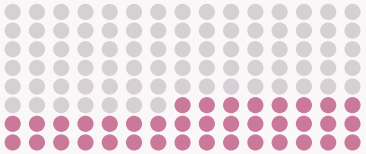
12 simulated units · M=3
Uncertain gains and biases

- Recorded node
- Stimulated node
- Response readout (one shown)

1 Recording agreement
40 independent networks

Single-response designs

68% 82 of 120 designs identical recording sets



Shared three-response designs

65% 26 of 40 designs identical recording sets



same recording set

2 Response error
Common MAP fit and budget
Same 40 networks

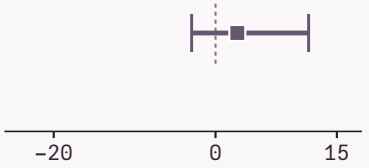
Single response

−3.7% [−18.5, +12.1]



Shared three-response

+2.7% [−3.0, +11.5]



Mean-MSE change vs nominal (%)

97.5% paired network-cluster CI

3 Risk forecasts
Fixed data and point prediction
40 new independent networks

19 of 40 favour prior averaging; 21 favour nominal

$$S(v,e)=\log v+e^2/v$$

v: MSE forecast; e: response error

One network accounts for 64% of the summed score difference

Forecast-score difference

−0.46 [−1.16, +0.02]



Prior-averaged minus nominal

95% paired network-cluster CI

Integrated stimulus response

$$q=\int \Delta r(t)\,dt$$

$$\Delta r(t)=r_{\text{stim}}(t)-r_{\text{control}}(t)$$

We use a **common MAP estimator**. Identical recording sets and data yield identical predictions.
Primary error and forecast-score intervals include zero.

Exploratory 100-unit rank-two family (8 independent networks): 4/8 setting-specific 95% intervals exclude zero.
All four favour prior averaging. These intervals are unadjusted; one point estimate favours nominal.